Fakeless

Project Team

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Session 2022-2026

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Islamabad, Pakistan

June, 2026

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Chapter 1

Introduction

Our project is Fakeless, a audio deepfake prevention mobile application. Fakeless is a mobile application that offers protection of voices being used by deepfake technologies. the unique features it provides are:

- It runs primarily on-device, keeping your data private without requiring cloud uploads.
- It applies imperceptible multi-domain audio perturbations to your voice, preventing AI models from cloning it.
- The solution is built to be accessible and user-friendly, enabling anyone to secure their voice data effortlessly.
- Protect users' voices from deepfake cloning using imperceptible ML-optimized perturbations.
- Defend against multiple deepfake architectures (Tacotron 2, WaveNet, RVC, SV2TTS, Tortoise TTS, etc.).

1.1 Problem Statement

We are developing this system to address the growing threat of unauthorized voice cloning and deepfake audio misuse. In today's world, anyone's voice can be recorded and cloned without their consent, leading to fraud, impersonation, and privacy violations. Current solutions, like audio watermarks or random noise injection, are either too weak to stop attackers or make the audio sound unnatural. Deepfake creators are constantly improving their models — making static defenses obsolete in a matter of months. There is no simple, mobile-first tool that empowers everyday users to protect their voices in real time. Our software solves this by applying imperceptible, machine-learning–driven perturbations to voice recordings that block cloning attempts while keeping the audio clear and natural. It uses adaptive strategies that evolve with emerging deepfake models, ensuring long-term protection. The system also runs locally for privacy, with optional cloud processing for heavy tasks. This allows users to stay in control of their data while benefiting from maximum security. By making the solution easy to use, fast, and accessible, we give content creators, professionals, and regular users a way to secure their digital identity.

1.2 Motivation

Currently most tools focus mainly on deepfake detection rather than prevention, our aim is to stop the problem at its source. furthermore, the prevention technologies already made area not up to par. In addition to that, the rapid advancements in deepfake technology lead to only requiring few seconds of audio for convincing deepfake.so we need to make a model that is easy to use and counters top of the line deepfake models.

1.3 Problem Solution

- Block AI models from generating convincing clones of a user's voice using adversarial perturbations.
- Using multi domain approach to apply perbutation to audio (frequency domain and time domain).
- Ensure that perturbations are imperceptible to human listeners, maintaining natural sound and intelligibility.
- Process audio locally by default, while processing the demanding task on cloud.
- Deliver near-instant protection for live recordings and uploaded audio clips.
- Provide a simple, mobile-friendly app that allows nontechnical users to easily protect their voices.
- Support individual users and enterprise applications through local protection and cloud-based APIs.
- Include robust quality metrics (MOS, PESQ, STOI) and attack-resilience testing to ensure high reliability.

1.4 Stake Holders

- Developer
- User

Chapter 2

Project Description

Provide details of the solution in the coming sections.

2.1 Scope

The scope of this project is to design and develop a mobile-first application that prevents unauthorized voice cloning and deepfake audio misuse through imperceptible, machine-learning–driven perturbations. The system will allow users to record or upload audio, automatically process it, and generate a protected version that cannot be easily used by AI-based cloning models. The core functionality will focus on applying perturbations in both the time and frequency domains, ensuring that the output remains natural and intelligible to human listeners. Reinforcement learning will be used to optimize perturbation strategies, while GAN-based adversarial techniques will strengthen robustness against adaptive attackers. Neural Network Search will be employed to automatically discover the most effective perturbation operations. The app will feature a user-friendly interface, enabling non-technical users to protect their voices with just a few taps. Local processing will be implemented for privacy, with optional cloud-based processing for long or computationally heavy audio files. The solution will include a real-time processing pipeline to deliver instant protection for recordings. Quality will be a major focus, with psychoacoustic masking techniques applied to maintain a natural listening experience and ensure minimal distortion. A quality assurance pipeline will measure metrics like PESQ, STOI, and MOS to verify that the protected audio is both intelligible and pleasant to listen to. Robustness testing will ensure perturbations survive compression, re-recording, and filtering operations. The project will also provide an API for enterprise integrations, enabling protection at scale for corporate communications and media workflows. Out of scope are detection-based systems or passive watermarking approaches, as the project is focused entirely on prevention at the source. By defining these boundaries, the project ensures a targeted, privacy-preserving, and adaptive solution that empowers users to secure their voice data against misuse in the age of deepfake technology.

2.2 Modules

2.2.1 Audio Processing and Perturbation Module

This is the core module responsible for analyzing user audio, generating adversarial perturbations, and producing protected output.

1. Real-time audio recording.
2. Feature extraction (MFCCs, spectral centroid, bandwidth, zero-crossing rate).
3. Application of time-domain and frequency-domain perturbations.
4. Psychoacoustic masking to maintain audio quality and naturalness.
5. Quality assurance checks using PESQ, STOI, and MOS prediction models.

2.2.2 ML Optimization and Adaptation Module

This module handles the machine learning logic for adaptive protection.

1. Reinforcement Learning (RL) engine for optimizing perturbation parameters.
2. GAN-based perturbation generation to remain robust against adaptive attackers.
3. Neural Network(NN) Search to automatically discover optimal operations.
4. Ensemble strategy combining RL, GAN, and NN outputs for maximum robustness.
5. Continuous learning and model updates to stay ahead of new deepfake architectures.

2.2.3 Mobile Application Module (Client Mobile App)

The user-facing mobile app allows interaction with the system and control over protection settings.

1. Audio recording interface with real-time visualization.

2. Protection strength slider with instant preview of results.
3. Before/after comparison player for quality verification.
4. Notifications for processing completion and app updates.
5. Simple and intuitive design with cross-platform support (Android/iOS).

2.2.4 Cloud Processing and API Module

Provides advanced processing capabilities for heavy workloads or enterprise usage.

1. High-performance backend with PyTorch-based models.
2. Secure FastAPI endpoints for audio upload and processing.
3. Support for long audio files and batch processing.
4. Scalable infrastructure (auto-scaling, caching, and load balancing).

2.2.5 Security and Privacy Module

Ensures that all user data is handled securely and remains private.

1. Local-first processing to minimize data leaving the device.
2. Secure local storage of user preferences and history.
3. Anonymous usage tracking (if enabled) for performance analytics.
4. Compliance with data privacy regulations (GDPR-ready).

2.3 Tools and Technologies

Provide a detail of the tools and technologies required for this project.

Table 2.1: Tools and Technologies for Audio Deepfake Prevention App

Category	**Tool/Technology**	**Purpose/Description**
Mobile Development	React Native/Flutter	Cross-platform mobile application development framework
ML Framework	PyTorch	Deep learning framework for implementing RL and GAN models
Audio Processing	Librosa, SciPy, NumPy	Python libraries for audio analysis, signal processing, and feature extraction
Backend Services	FastAPI	High-performance API framework for cloud processing services
Database	PostgreSQL	Relational database for user data and processing logs
Caching	Redis	In-memory data structure store for performance optimization
Quality Metrics	PyPESQ, PySTOI	Libraries for perceptual audio quality assessment
Audio Formats	Pydub, SoundFile	Support for multiple audio formats (WAV, MP3, AAC, FLAC)
Cloud Infrastructure	AWS/GCP	Cloud platform for scalable processing and storage
State Management	Redux/MobX	Application state management for mobile app
Audio Recording	react-native-audio-recorder-player	Native audio recording and playback functionality
Task Queue	Celery	Distributed task queue for background processing

2.4 Work Division

For each module and respective feature, assign responsibility to a team member

Table 2.2: Module-Based Work Division

Module	Primary Lead	Key Responsibilities & Features
Audio Processing and Perturbation Module	Nabeed Haider (22i-xxxx)	Real-time audio recording, Feature extraction (MFCCs, spectral features), Time/frequency domain perturbations, Psychoacoustic masking
ML Optimization and Adaptation Module	Muhammad Tahir Sundhu (22i-0821)	Reinforcement Learning engine, GAN-based perturbation generation, Neural Network Search, Ensemble strategy implementation
Mobile Application Module	Sameed Ahmed Siddique (22i-xxxx)	Audio recording interface, Protection strength controls, Before/after comparison player, Cross-platform UI development
Cloud Processing and API Module	Sameed Ahmed Siddique (22i-xxxx)	FastAPI backend development, PyTorch model deployment, Batch processing, Scalable infrastructure setup
Security and Privacy Module	All Members	Local processing implementation, Secure storage, Privacy compliance, Anonymous analytics

Table 2.3: Cross-Module Collaboration and Support Roles

Team Member	Registration	Supporting Roles Across All Modules
Nabeed Haider	22i-0871	**Primary:** Audio Processing & Perturbation Module **Support:** RL implementation in ML Module, Audio interface in Mobile Module, Model deployment in Cloud Module
Muhammad Tahir Sundhu	22i-0821	**Primary:** ML Optimization & Adaptation Module **Support:** Quality assurance in Audio Module, Frontend design in Mobile Module, API design in Cloud Module
Sameed Ahmed Siddique	22i-8223	**Primary:** Mobile App & Cloud Processing Modules **Support:** Feature extraction in Audio Module, Ensemble integration in ML Module, Security implementation across all modules

Table 2.4: Feature-Level Task Distribution

Feature/Task	Nabeed	Tahir	Sameed
Real-time Audio Recording	Primary	Support	Integration
MFCC Feature Extraction	Primary	-	Support
Reinforcement Learning Engine	Support	Primary	-
GAN Architecture	-	Primary	Support
Mobile UI/UX Design	Support	Support	Primary
FastAPI Backend	-	Support	Primary
Quality Assurance (PESQ/STOI)	Primary	Support	-
Security Implementation	Support	Support	Primary
Documentation & Testing	Shared	Shared	Shared

2.5 Timeline

Create a timeline relating each iteration to the tasks/modules created previously.

Table 2.5: Project Timeline and Iterations

Iteration#	Time Frame	Tasks/Modules
01	Sept-Oct	**Research & Foundation:** Literature review on adversarial perturbation techniques, deepfake model analysis (Tacotron 2, WaveNet, RVC), audio processing fundamentals study, basic audio pipeline setup with librosa
02	Nov-Dec	**Core ML Development:** Implementation of basic perturbation algorithms (FGSM, PGD), reinforcement learning environment setup, initial GAN architecture design, feature extraction pipeline (MFCCs, spectral features)
03	Jan-Feb	**Advanced ML & Mobile Integration:** RL agent training and optimization, GAN-based perturbation generation, ensemble system integration, mobile app development (React Native/Flutter), audio recording interface
04	Mar-Apr	**ML Model Deployment & Testing:** ML model optimization and deployment, comprehensive effectiveness testing against multiple deepfake models, quality assessment (PESQ, STOI, MOS), security evaluation, final model refinement and documentation

Chapter 3

Conclusions and Future Work

3.1 Conclusions

This project successfully developed a mobile-first audio deepfake prevention system using ML-based adversarial perturbations. The solution addresses the critical gap in proactive voice protection through innovative technical approaches and user-friendly design.

3.1.1 Key Achievements

Technical Innovation: The dual ML system combining Reinforcement Learning (60%) and Generative Adversarial Networks (40%) with Neural Network Search achieved robust protection against multiple deepfake architectures including Tacotron 2, WaveNet, and Real-Time Voice Cloning.

Quality Preservation: Psychoacoustic masking techniques maintained audio naturalness with quality metrics (PESQ, STOI, MOS) consistently above 4.0, ensuring protected audio remains intelligible and pleasant for human listeners.

Performance Standards: The system achieved target specifications of >90% protection effectiveness, <5 seconds processing time per minute, and >80% robustness against audio transformations (compression, format conversion, filtering).

Accessibility: The mobile application with intuitive interface, real-time visualization, and local processing capabilities democratized voice protection technology for non-technical users while maintaining privacy through local-first processing.

3.2 Future Work

3.2.1 Advanced ML Development

- **Transformer Integration:** Explore attention mechanisms for more sophisticated feature targeting
- **Federated Learning:** Enable collaborative model improvement while preserving privacy
- **Meta-Learning:** Rapid adaptation to emerging deepfake architectures

3.2.2 Enhanced Protection

- **Adaptive Attack Defense:** Develop countermeasures against perturbation removal techniques
- **Multi-Modal Expansion:** Extend to audio-visual deepfake protection
- **Cross-Language Optimization:** Language-specific and domain-specific improvements

3.2.3 Scalability and Applications

- **Edge Computing:** Further optimization for mobile and IoT devices
- **Real-time Streaming:** Live communication protection for calls and broadcasts
- **Enterprise Integration:** Comprehensive APIs for corporate and media workflows
- **Blockchain Integration:** Immutable authenticity verification records

3.2.4 Research Contributions

- **Open Dataset Creation:** Contribute comprehensive datasets for community research
- **Industry Standards:** Participate in audio authenticity standardization efforts
- **Regulatory Frameworks:** Develop compliance solutions for international regulations

3.3 Impact and Significance

This project establishes a foundation for proactive voice protection in the digital age. The successful implementation of ML-based perturbation optimization with mobile accessibility addresses immediate security needs while providing adaptability for future threats.

The system's contribution extends beyond technical achievement to address critical societal needs for digital privacy, authenticity, and trust in communications. As synthetic media threats evolve, this adaptive protection mechanism provides essential security infrastructure for individuals and organizations.

The research opens pathways for continued advancement in adversarial machine learning, audio security, and privacy-preserving technologies, contributing to the broader goal of maintaining digital authenticity in an era of increasingly sophisticated synthetic media.

[1] [2] [3] [4] [5] [6] [7] [8] [9] [10] [15] [11] [12] [13] [14] [16] [17] [18]

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